How-To Library

Informatica

Address Verification Best Practices for Belgium

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Abstract

This document provides a high-level overview of the Informatica Address Verification, powered by AddressDoctor, support for Belgium address verification. This document also contains information about best practices that you can implement to optimize the Belgium address verification.

Supported Versions

- Informatica AddressDoctor 5.7.0 and later
- Informatica AddressDoctor Cloud 2.0 and later

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Languages and Character Set

You can configure Informatica Address Verification to return the province, locality, and street information in Belgium addresses in English, Flemish, French, or German. By default, Address Verification returns validated Belgium addresses in the main language of the region to which the address belongs. The following sections explain the multilanguage support for Belgium addresses.

The default character set for Belgium addresses is Latin 1 - Western European.

Multilanguage Support for Belgium Addresses

You can configure Address Verification to return the province, locality, and street information in valid Belgium addresses in English, Flemish, French, or German.

To set the preferred language, configure the `PreferredLanguage` attribute of the `Result` element in `Parameters.xml`.

The following table describes the `PreferredLanguage` values that you can set for Belgium address data:

Option	Description
DATABASE	Default value. Returns addresses in the main language of the region to which the address belongs. The address might be Flemish, French, or German based on the region.
ENGLISH	Returns the province, locality, and street information in English if the reference address database contains the information in English. Returns the other address elements in the main language of the region to which the address belongs.
ALTERNATIVE_1	Returns the province, locality, and street information in Flemish.
ALTERNATIVE_2	Returns the province, locality, and street information in French.
ALTERNATIVE_3	Returns the province, locality, and street information in German.
PRESERVE_INPUT	Returns addresses in the language that the input address uses. Address Verification preserves the language if the reference database contains the address data in the input language. If the input address contains more than one language, Address Verification returns the output in the database language.

Example: PreferredLanguage Settings and Results for Belgium

You enter the following Belgium address for verification:

```
Rue Royale 4
Bruxelles 1000
Belgium
```

The following table shows the validated results for different `PreferredLanguage` settings when you enter the address:

DATABASE	ENGLISH	ALTERNATIVE_1 (Flemish)	ALTERNATIVE_2 (French)	ALTERNATIVE_3 (German)	PRESERVE_INPUT
Output address Rue Royale 4 1000 Bruxelles Belgium	**Output address** Rue Royale 4 1000 Brussels Belgium	**Output address** Koningsstraat 4 1000 Brussel Belgium	**Output address** Rue Royale 4 1000 Bruxelles Belgium	**Output address** Rue Royale 4 1000 Brüssel Belgium	**Output address** Rue Royale 4 Bruxelles 1000 Belgium
EERS: 005050500000 00000000	**EERS:** 005000E000000 0000000	**EERS:** 005000000000000 00000	**EERS:** 005000000000000 0000000	**EERS:** 005000E000000 0000000	**EERS:** 005000000000000 00000

The tagble also includes the EERS codes for each address.

The table indicates that the input address and the results for DATABASE, ALTERNATIVE_2, and PRESERVE_INPUT are in French. The result for ALTERNATIVE_1 is Flemish. The table indicates that the street information is available only in Flemish and French.

Note: An EERS value of 5 at position seven (Street) for the DATABASE setting indicates that the database contains alternatives: Flemish in this case. For ENGLISH and for ALTERNATIVE_3, the EERS value for position seven is E. An EERS value of E indicates that the output is in the default database language, French, because the information is not available in the specified language.

Process Modes

You can process Belgium addresses in the following process modes:

- BATCH
- COUNTRYRECOGNITION
- INTERACTIVE
- FASTCOMPLETION
- PARSE

Informatica Address Verification verifies addresses in batch, interactive, and fast completion modes.

Address Format and Address Examples

A typical Belgium address contains the following elements in the given order:

```
RECIPIENT
[FLOOR] [APARTMENT]
[BUILDING] [URBANIZATION]
STREET_TYPE STREET_NAME HOUSE_NUMBER
POSTAL_CODE LOCALITY
BELGIUM
```

Note that elements such as the floor, apartment, building, and urbanization are optional. Informatica Address Verification verifies Belgium addresses only up to the premises number. Based on the order you enter the information, Address Verification copies any additional information in the input to the building and subbuilding fields.

The following table lists the address elements in a Belgium address and provides examples:

Address Elements	Example 1	Example 2
RECIPIENT	Informatica Belgium	-
[FLOOR] [APARTMENT]	-	-
[BUILDING] [URBANIZATION]	-	-
POST BOX	-	Postbus 24
STREET_TYPE STREET_NAME HOUSE_NUMBER	Dijkweg 13	-
POSTAL_CODE LOCALITY	9031 Drongen	9000 Gent Centrum
COUNTRY	Belgium	Belgium
Complete Address	Informatica Belgium Dijkweg 13 9031 Drongen BELGIUM	Postbus 24 9000 Gent Centrum BELGIUM

Key Address Elements

The following elements in a Belgium address are very important for address verification:

Street Name

House Number

Locality

Informatica Address Verification verifies Belgium addresses only up to the house number level.

Address Enrichments

You can configure Informatica Address Verification to include the following enrichments in the verified Belgium addresses:

Enrichments	Database	Notes
CAMEO	`BEL5CA.MD`	Retrieve the CAMEO profiles from the Callcredit Information Group as enrichment to valid Belgium addresses. CAMEO profiles provide consumer classification systems that indicate the socio-economic and geo-demographic profiles of neighborhoods across the world.
Arrival Point Geocoding	`BEL5GCAP.MD`	Retrieve the arrival point geocoordinates for verified Belgium addresses.
Geocoding	`BEL5GC.MD`	Retrieve the standard, interpolated geocoordinates for verified Belgium addresses.
Country-specific Enrichments	`BEL5E1.MD`	Retrieve a combination of National Institute of Statistics (StatBel) or NIS codes and Neighborhood ID as an enrichment to verified Belgium addresses.

Address Verification Tips and Best Practices

Note the following points when you verify Belgium addresses:

- Set the `AliasLocality` attribute of the `Result` element in `Parameters.xml` to OFFICIAL to receive the main locality, Communiteit or Communité, name in the Locality field of the result output. The Belgium Mail organization mandates that you use the Communiteit or Communité name as the locality name. However, a postal code might resolve to the dependent locality name, which Informatica Address Verification then returns as the locality name.
  If you set the `AliasLocality` attribute of the `Result` element in `Parameters.xml` to OFF, Address Verification returns the dependent locality name in the Locality field.

  If you set the `AliasLocality` attribute of the `Result` element in `Parameters.xml` to PRESERVE, Address Verification copies the locality name in the input to the result output.
- House numbers in Belgium remain contiguous for the entire stretch of street even if the street goes through multiple dependent localities. For example, Houtstraat 12 and Houtstraat 14 could be two different dependent localities.
- Post offices in Belgium assign PO Box, Postbus, or BP numbers independently and do not follow any specific pattern. So, Address Verification always validates the PO Box number.
- You can input Belgium addresses either in the AddressLines format or as address elements.

Frequently Asked Questions

Is province information available for Belgium?

Yes. The Belgium reference address databases contain the province information in Flemish, French, and German languages.

What is the maximum number of AddressLines in a Belgium address?

According to the Universal Postal Union specifications, the maximum number of address lines, including country information, in a Belgium address is six.

How important is house number information in a Belgium address?

A valid Belgium address always contains a house number. Informatica Address Verification requires the house number information to verify a Belgium address. Informatica reference data for batch, interactive, and fast completion modes contain detailed house number information.

Does Belgium reference data contain building or sub-building information?

No. Informatica reference data files for batch, interactive, and fast completion modes contain detailed house number information, but they do not contain building or sub-building information.

Does Address Verification support Flemish, French, and German output for all Belgium addresses?

Yes, you can configure Address Verification to return Province, Locality, and Street information for all Belgium addresses in Flemish, French, or German.

Reference Address Databases

Informatica updates the reference address databases for Belgium once every quarter. You can download the latest database packages from the Informatica Database Download portal. For news about reference address databases and software updates for Address Verification, subscribe to the UpData newsletter from Informatica.

Informatica Address Verification supports the following reference databases for Belgium addresses:

- `BEL5GCAP.MD`. For arrival point geocoding.
- `BEL5BI.MD`. For batch and interactive verification.
- `BEL5CA.MD`. For CAMEO consumer segmentation.
- `BEL5E1.MD`. For country-specific enrichments.
- `BEL5FC.MD`. For fast completion verification.
- `BEL5GC.MD`. For standard geocoding.

Additional Documentation Resources

For more information about Informatica Address Verification features and configuration, see the latest Address Verification documentation at:

https://network.informatica.com/community/informatica-network/products/data_quality/data-as-a-service/places

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